Intimacy is for Every**body:**

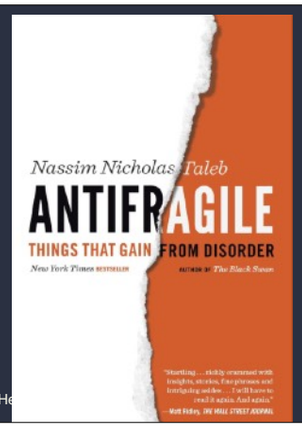
Diversity & Intimacy Coaching 2

Onika Henry (Clinical Sexologist & Sex Educator)

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Antifragility - A concept developed by Nassim Nicholas Taleb[i] to refer to systems that increase their capability to thrive as a result of stressors, shocks, volatility, uncertainty, mistakes, attacks or failures.

Antifragility goes beyond robustness and resilience to describe things that gain from disorder. Whilst a resilient system may seek to "bounce back" after a disaster, an antifragile system seeks to "bounce forward". From personal and professional realms, antifragility has a lot to add to our worldview.

[i] Taleb, N., 2012. Antifragile. London: Penguin.

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2

At Dusk

It was that time of evening, just before dark. The house was empty except for the two of them. As they lay together entwined in a warm embrace, this room, this bed, was the universe.

She stroked the nape of his neck. He nuzzled her erect nipple, first gently with his nose, then licked it, tasted, smelled and absorbed her body odour. It was a hot and humid August day, and they had been perspiring.

Slowly, he caressed her breast as he softly rolled his face over the contours of the other. He pressed his body close against her, sighed, and completely tired, closed his eyes and soon fell into a deep sleep.

Ever so slowly she slipped herself out from under him, for fear she would disturb him; she cradled him in her arms and then moved him to his crib. Having completed his 6 o'clock feeding, the 4-month[illegible]d just experienced another important step toward his sexual development.



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- Some would not recognise any sexual overtones at all
- Others may be surprised that it isn't sexual in the way it first seemed to be



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- It suggests the important early beginnings of our sexual development
- It reminds us that what we assume to be sexual or erotic, does not always remain true for all situations and cultures.



5

Worldview
What is this?

6

7

- A worldview (or "world view") is a set of assumptions about physical and social reality that may have powerful effects on cognition and behavior.

(Koltko-Rivera, Mark. (2004). The Psychology of Worldviews. Review of General Psychology. 8. 3-58. 10.1037/1089-2680.8.1.3.



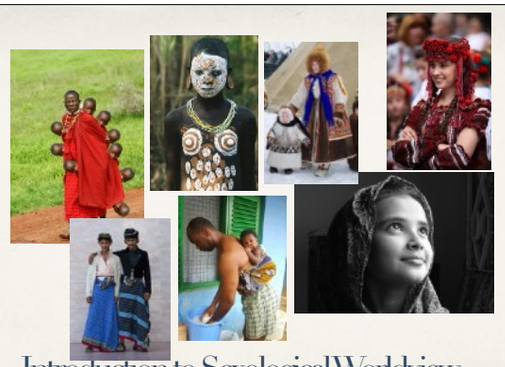
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- A worldview is a collection of attitudes, values, stories and expectations about the world around us, which inform our every thought and action. Worldview is expressed in ethics, religion, philosophy, scientific beliefs and so on (Sire, 2004).



Sire, J. W. (2004) Naming the Elephant: Worldview as a Concept. Intervarsity Press. [Google Scholar]

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Introduction to Sexological Worldview

10

Sexological worldview is the lens through which someone sees and makes meaning of the sexual world around them.



Sitron, Justin A., and Li Lock. 2021. "Sexological Worldview Development Explained by the Developmental Model of Intercultural Sensitivity." American Journal of Sexuality Education 17 (1): 106–24. doi:10.1080/15546128.2021.1960665.

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Sexological worldview is the often unexamined but changeable perspective held by each person about the world around them with regards to sexuality. It emerges throughout life experience and the socialization process and is influenced by the presence or absence of infinite combinations of the following components and their variations: culture, knowledge, values, beliefs, religion or spirituality, opinions, attitudes and concepts specific to sexuality, relationship style and type, sexual behavior, sexual orientation, and gender identity.



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Sexological worldview develops across a continuum with worldviews at one end being expressed as "dualistic (right or wrong)" and at the opposing end as "relativist (possible perspectives are endless and no one perspective is right or wrong)" and varied expressions in between.



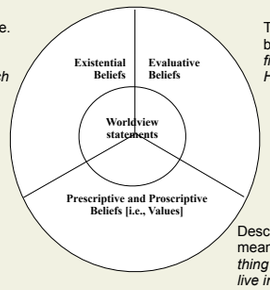
Model of Worldview Statements

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Model of Worldview Statements

Capable of being true or false. E.g. - *There exists a God or Goddess who cares for me personally; Scientific research is a reliable way to establish the truth*



The object of belief is judged to be good or bad. E.g. *Those who fight against my nation are evil or Human nature is basically good*

Describe preferred means or ends. E.g. *The thing to do in life is to live in the moment*

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Not all beliefs are worldview beliefs. Beliefs regarding:

- the underlying nature of reality
- "proper" social relations or guidelines for living
- the existence or nonexistence of important entities

are worldview beliefs. Other beliefs are not.

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EXERCISE

Can you identify the different kinds of Worldview statements in the worksheet? Let's Try!

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Diversity
What is it really?

17

When we usually think about diversity and cultural differences (especially when engaging with sexual minority communities…):

- What often comes to mind?
- What does it look like?
- What are some of the challenges?

18

Food For Thought:

- Society: artificial, institution based, structured
- Communities: developed by the people, naturally occurring, structured but not clearly
- Culture vs. Subculture – What are some of the norms of minority communities that may not be in society?

19

The Intersections

20

Orientation & The Workplace

Gender & Behaviour

Norms about risk & Sexual ID

Racial stereotypes & Sexual minorities

"Fun" sex & Orientation

Travel & sexual identity

Social class & Sexual ID

Personality theory & sexual minorities

Minority families of choice & Minority families of birth

Health care & gender ID

Politics & Sexual Minorities Internal and external

Sexual ID in the classroom

Language & sexual minority communities

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When we think about diversity and cultural differences given the prior new concepts:

- What comes to mind now?
- What does it look like?
- What are some of the challenges we can anticipate for ourselves?

**(Break out rooms - Think, Share, Discuss, Examples)*

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Forces/Influences on Sexological Worldview

- AASKK Cognition
- Developmental Model of Intercultural Sensitivity (Perceptual Experience of Difference)
- Dimensions of Culture & Cultural Dimensions Scale

**(Handouts)*

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Sexological Worldview & Coaching

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Forces Contributing to Sexological Worldview Dev.



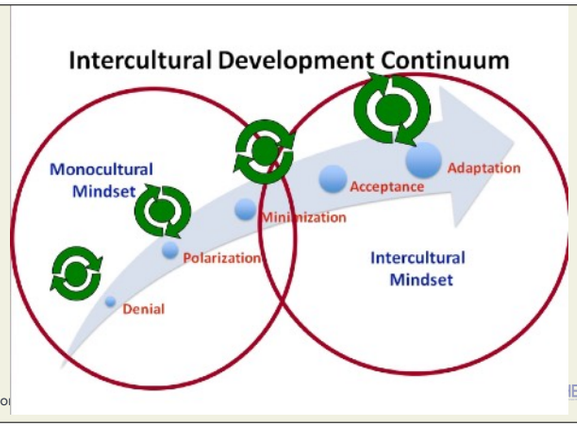
AASKK Cognition is:

- -Awareness of one's own worldview
- -Awareness of sexological diversity
- -Self-efficacy about worldview development
- -Knowledge about effects of diversity
- -Knowledge about Worldview and the Intercultural Development Continuum

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Intercultural Development Continuum



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Stereotypes vs, Generalisations & Frameworks

(Hammer, 2009)

Stereotypes

- Evaluative overgeneralisations, personal traits are assigned to a group
- Support less complex perceptions & experiences of cultural differences and commonalities

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Stereotypes vs, Generalisations & Frameworks

Generalisations & Frameworks

- Neutral, relative descriptions of a group's preferences
- Support complex perceptions & experiences of differences and commonalities

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Accepting & Adaptive Behaviours

(Hammer, 2009)

- Ask questions, seek understanding
- Engage in careful curiosity
- Watch for role models and mimic or tailor their behaviour to your natural self
- Seek key informants & cultural ambassadors

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Accepting & Adaptive Behaviours

(Hammer, 2009)

- Find reliable sources and literature recommended by the population
- Spend the time & practice!
- Remember: AASKK Cognition

An Invitation To Apply The Knowledge
(Case Studies, Vignettes)

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